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In this article, the authors propose that in the long run, a nonprofit organization with supportively oriented positioning (e.g., promoting a cause) is likely to survive longer and achieve more donations compared with a nonprofit with a combative orientation (e.g., fighting against something). To test this proposition, the authors adopt a three-pronged approach that (1) uses publicly available financial data from nonprofits' tax filings over a ten-year period, (2) measures annual donor pledges from a field study with a registered nonprofit organization, and (3) examines actual donation behavior of participants in a longitudinal lab study. Moreover, the authors test this proposition for donations of money as well as time. They consider various theoretical mechanisms that might cause the proposed effect, such as regulatory focus theory, inertia in giving, and the preponderance of supportive charities.

Keywords: promotion orientation, prevention orientation, charitable giving, regulatory focus theory, longitudinal analysis

What's in a Message? The Longitudinal Influence of a Supportive Versus Combative Orientation on the Performance of Nonprofits

Companies that operate in the marketplace for profit use many different methods to persuade consumers, including advertising, sales promotion, free trials, and more. However, nonprofit organizations[1] face a unique challenge. Although they too must persuade consumers, they are often limited in the extent to which they can afford advertisements and promotion tools (Dixon 1997). Indeed, money spent on advertisements might be perceived as reducing the total amount going toward the cause, which raises questions about the desirability of allocating excessive amounts to marketing (Ritchie, Swami, and Weinberg 1999). With approximately two-thirds of households donating more than $2,000 per year to one or more of the half-million charities in the United States (Center on Philanthropy at Indiana University 2007), competition is fierce for the bulk of charitable organizations facing the aforementioned challenges.

What more can charitable organizations do to persuade people to continue donating over time? Often, an effective tool to communicate their aims and persuade donors lies in an organization's name or supporting communication. This includes a charity's brand name, tagline, or mission statement, which may signal to prospective donors the charity's intent. For example, "Mothers Against Drunk Driving" captures all the aims and emotions of the cause, and thus, the name itself acts as a critical persuasion tool. In addition, words included in the tagline (e.g., "fight," "stop," "pre-

[1]For ease of reference, hereinafter, we use the terms "charity" and "charitable organization" to mean nonprofit organizations.

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vent") may evoke the nature or tone of the cause. Given that the tone conveyed by the brand name and supporting communications plays an important role in garnering contributions, how can charities use them to keep donors engaged? Could the nature of these communications influence long-term revenue generated by charitable organizations and, thus, survival and growth? In this research, we examine the influence of a combative versus supportive orientation of a charity's cause on its ability to survive and succeed. For example, a nonprofit organization in the environmental domain could frame its cause more supportively as "Citizens for Urban Renewal" or more combatively as "Citizens Fighting Urban Decay"; alternatively, it could adopt a neutral orientation: "Citizenship of Urban Planning." For ease of reference, hereinafter we refer to these types of names as combative, supportive, and neutral orientations, respectively.

We attempt to answer the following specific questions in this research. First, is a supportively oriented charity more likely to survive than a combatively oriented charity, or vice versa? Second, would a supportive orientation garner greater contributions, or vice versa? Finally, if differences do exist on the basis of orientation, what theoretical mechanisms can help explain such differences? To answer these questions, we adopt a three-pronged approach. First, we analyze the key financial performance measures and firm attributes as submitted by tax-exempt nonprofits to the Internal Revenue Service (IRS), which includes more than 400,000 public charities spanning a ten-year period. Second, we conduct a field study with a nonprofit organization and examine how people's annual pledges may vary. Third, we conduct a controlled longitudinal lab study to provide a converging test for the long-term effectiveness of a combative versus supportive orientation. We find that a supportively oriented charity exhibits greater survival and revenue compared with a combatively oriented charity.

We examine data over the long run, which is an important contribution of our research because the differential influence of framing has been less explored over time. In addition, to the best of our knowledge, no research has investigated the differential influence of framing for charitable organizations. Longitudinal techniques (relative to point-in-time measurements) have been historically underutilized, partly due to data limitations and researchers' preferences for a priori theory-based foundations (Dekimpe and Hanssens 2000). However, researchers have alluded to the importance of understanding long-term effects because a point-in-time study may fail to capture the temporal influences of variables on outcomes. It might also be that variables that seem influential in a point-in-time study have relatively less influence when studied over time (Jacoby, Szybillo, and Berning 1976). Moreover, research has shown that biases and inconsistencies in judgments disappear in repeated trials because people can learn from past behavior (Coursey, Hovis, and Schulze 1987). Therefore, a longitudinal examination has benefits relative to cross-sectional studies because it enables researchers to better understand enduring consumer commitment (Morgan and Hunt 1994). In the next section, we examine various streams of literature to shed light on the theoretical mechanism that might be at work in causing the proposed effect.

THEORETICAL BACKGROUND

If we broadly classify the charity's name and supporting communications as the message received by the donor, we can begin to understand the theoretical underpinnings of our proposed effect using previous findings in the domain of message framing. For example, extant research has demonstrated that contextual factors such as level of processing or nature of the message can moderate the influence of a message frame. However, although there is sufficient research on message framing and its downstream influences, we find that much of the empirical evidence is about short-term attitude change and uses one-time experimental manipulations. Thus, this extant research offers few insights on examining a charity's long-term survival and revenue growth. A charity is likely to survive longer through a greater ability to garner donations. An important factor that serves to sustain commitment is the donor's motivation. In other words, there should be a fit between the motivation espoused by the charity and the motivation felt by the donor. Thus, we look to the area of regulatory motivations (or focus) and the related area of goal commitment to derive predictions about the success of combative versus supportive orientations in the long run. However, note that we do not suggest that only regulatory focus theory could be at work in driving the proposed effect; the effect has two aspects—(1) an initial interest in donating to a charity and (2) a sustained perseverance to keep donating—and thus, many factors could be at work in driving the effect at different points in time. In this research, we try to tease out the influence of regulatory focus theory within our field and lab studies, and we suggest that further research should test the influence of other possible mechanisms that could be at work. Because we examine the role of regulatory focus theory in greater detail than potential theories, our theoretical review is more focused on regulatory focus theory. However, we acknowledge and discuss how other accounts might influence the effect.

In regulatory focus theory, although both promotion- and prevention-focused strategies are goal-attainment strategies, they are distinct in that a promotion focus involves sensitivity to positive outcomes (emphasizing advancement, attainment, and accomplishment), whereas a prevention focus involves sensitivity to negative outcomes (emphasizing caution and protection) (Pennington and Roese 2003). In other words, success under a promotion orientation results in a focus on the presence of positives, whereas failure under a prevention orientation results in a focus on the presence of negatives. Therefore, a message's framing has the ability to activate a promotion or prevention orientation (Pham and Higgins 2005).[2] For example, Zhou and Pham (2004) find that a person's evaluation of financial products framed as "individual stocks in a trading account" versus "mutual funds in a retirement account" activate a promotion versus a prevention orientation, respectively. Promotion and prevention motivations also influence decisions by generating different mindsets: a promotion focus engenders a more global, top-down mindset, whereas a prevention focus promotes a local, bottom-up mindset (Pham and Higgins 2005).

[2]Similarly, related research in goals-based choice has suggested that a person's motives can be elicited by simple contextual cues (Fishbach and Dhar 2008).

Applying the theoretical predictions of regulatory focus theory to our research context, we propose that a supportively oriented charity is more likely to activate a promotion focus, whereas a combatively oriented charity is more likely activate a prevention focus. For example, if we consider our initial example of two charities named "Citizens for Urban Renewal" (which seems more aligned with an advancement focus) versus "Citizens Fighting Urban Decay" (which seems more related to correcting a problem), one could argue that the former charity name espouses a promotion motivation and thus activates (or is preferred by donors with) a promotion focus, while the latter activates a prevention focus.

However, such an activation of promotion or prevention focus may be limited to the initial exposure to name or message. An important question is, How does regulatory motivation influence long-term behavior? We find some evidence of the long-term influence of regulatory focus in prior research. Specifically, Pennington and Roese (2003) test for the influence of regulatory focus on temporal decisions. They find that because promotion-focused goals are more ongoing and abstract, they are more likely to include a time frame exceeding that of prevention-focused goals (which tend to be more immediate and concrete). Therefore, this research would suggest that people who are pursuing promotion-focused goals are more likely to persist because they believe that the goal is of a more ongoing nature rather than one with a clear end. In contrast, those pursuing prevention-focused goals expect more immediate results and perceive the objective more concretely. They are less likely to persist for as long. Similarly, research has reported that when a purchase occasion is more temporally distant, promotion- (vs. prevention-) framed products become more appealing (Mogliner, Aaker, and Pennington 2008). Moreover, a global mindset is said to result in choice highlighting—that is, greater motivation to work toward the focal goal and away from alternate goals, leading to goal-congruent actions (Fishbach and Dhar 2008). Applying work on regulatory motivations—specifically, the influence of regulatory focus on temporally framed goals—to our charity context, one could argue that a supportive charity activates a promotion orientation that leads to greater commitment to the charity's cause. Thus, a supportive (vs. combative) orientation would result in greater resources invested in ensuring that the charity's cause is achieved. In other words, donors are more likely to persist, thereby increasing the likelihood of greater survival of a supportively oriented charity.

Using the research on regulatory focus theory, we can make the following predictions. A supportively oriented charity seems more aligned with advancement and, thus, can be categorized as triggering a promotion focus. In contrast, a combatively oriented charity seems more aligned with trying to correct a problem and, thus, can be categorized as triggering a prevention focus. We can further infer that because a promotion orientation engenders a more global mindset, which results in greater goal commitment, a supportively oriented charity is more likely to have sustained donations. Moreover, the global, top-down processing that occurs in a promotion orientation encourages a greater amount of time invested in trying to achieve the goal. Thus, we predict that a supportive charity is likely to have greater revenue because donors are likely to remain committed to supporting the cause for a longer time.

Importantly, as mentioned previously, other theoretical mechanisms could be at work in causing the predicted longitudinal influence.[3] In investigating the charitable organization landscape, we find that supportively oriented charities are much more prevalent than combatively framed charities. Thus, it is quite possible that people consider supportive charities more popular (because of their frequency) and believe that such charities are more worth their sustained donations. Moreover, this greater frequency could signal to prospective donors that such charities are more liked by others, which could also increase likelihood of donating. That is, if supportive charities are inferred to be more popular, the social influence of donating to a charity considered popular among others is likely to afford greater donor satisfaction. In addition, if a charity is perceived to be more popular, donors may believe that its cause is more likely to be achieved because it is likely to attract more donations. Therefore, donating to a cause that is likely to succeed seems like a more justifiable decision. Along the same lines, because the combatively named charities appear less frequently, people might find them to be more novel and unfamiliar, which could lead donors to be more cautious in donating to them, resulting in less revenue. The rarity of the combative charities could also send out the cue that they are not as long lasting. Finally, it is possible that charities with a short-term focus are more likely to choose a combative orientation, and those that are of an ongoing nature are named supportively. To some extent, we address this concern in our field and lab studies. In our field study, for example, the same charity is framed with supportive or combative messaging, and our lab study examines the same cause with the charity name manipulated to be supportive versus combative.

Using longitudinal charity data, a field study, and a longitudinal lab study, we test these theoretical predictions for both money and time. In addition to the theoretical mechanism described in this section, we also present further theoretical predictions before each of our empirical investigations that test different aspects of the regulatory focus theory that underlie our proposed effects. Moreover, we discuss other potential accounts that could be at work in causing the proposed effect.

LONGITUDINAL DATA

We first describe the longitudinal data used to test our predictions, which consist of key measures as publicly reported for registered nonprofits. Second, we discuss the method used to categorize each charity's name as either supportive or combative. Third, we compare overall survival and financial performance between the supportive and combative orientations. This procedure enables us to test the predictions regarding the longevity and revenue-generating ability of the charities as a function of their supportive or combative orientation.

Data

To empirically test our propositions, we obtained extant data including charity performance measures that enabled us to examine the impact of a supportive versus combative

[3]We gratefully acknowledge the editor's recommendation to consider the different potential accounts that could cause the proposed effect.

orientation on charity survival and revenue. The data consisted of key financial measures and firm attributes as submitted by tax-exempt nonprofit organizations to the IRS, which includes approximately 400,000 public charities spanning a ten-year period (2000–2009). They offer a comprehensive set of standardized data on tax-exempt organizations; the Urban Institute's National Center for Charitable Statistics (NCCS; http://nccsdataweb.urban.org) gathers the data, which comprise descriptive and financial information generated from applications charities have filed with the IRS. In general, organizations that are not required to submit this information (e.g., religious organizations, organizations with less than $25,000 in gross receipts) are excluded from the file (Urban Institute NCCS 2006). Therefore, our data set includes nondenominational charitable organizations with revenue greater than $25,000.

The revenue measure includes dollars from all activities conducted in support of a charitable organization's tax-exempt purposes and is given in our model as $REVENUE_{it}$, which represents the revenue for charity i at time t. The asset measure ($ASSET_{it}$) includes such items as real estate, pledge receivables, and inventories and provides us with an effective measure of charity size. That is, if assets measure the economic value of the firm's resources, it would indicate that greater amounts of resources are likely to be held by larger firms. Thus, assets serve as a control measure for firm size. The name of the charity ($NAME_i$) enables us to categorize it as supportive, combative, or neutral (we outline the procedure of categorizing names in detail in the next section). We calculated a time-varying age variable (AGE_{it}) from each organization's founding date as provided in its IRS filing. This variable provides a consistently obtained measure of duration in the marketplace, hypothesized to reflect a charity's ability to generate revenue through long-term donations. To account for differences that may exist between charitable domains, we chose the variable of charitable class ($CLASS_i$) in line with the definitive classification system of the National Taxonomy of Exempt Entities (which includes Arts and Culture, Education, Health, Human Services, and Other). Moreover, we included the variables of geography ($STATE_i$) and the NCCS's confidence rating ($RATING_i$) for charity i's class designation (A, B, or C).

Before testing our hypothesis, we transformed REVENUE and ASSET measures into their natural log to induce linearity (Tabachnick and Fidell 2002). With some charities reporting negative revenue—and with the natural log of a number less than 1 being undefined—we rescaled by an amount equal to the lowest reported value plus 1. It is worth noting that the pattern of results for the non-log-transformed values was similar to the log-transformed values. Next, we describe the method we used for categorizing charities as supportive or combative because such a classification was absent from current reported measures.

Categorizing Charities as Combative Versus Supportive

Classification method. We classified charities as having a supportive, combative, or neutral orientation through an automated coding schema. The procedure began with a keyword search task including possible synonyms pertaining to a charity's supportive or combative orientation. For example, we classified charities that included descriptors such as "against," "anti-," "fight(ing)," or "opposing" as combative, whereas we coded charities that included keywords such as "for," "support," "aid(ing)," "helping," or "assisting" as supportive. We coded the remaining charities as having a neutral orientation. Although neutral classifications were not pertinent to our main analyses, their inclusion provides a conservative reliability test for our coding schema. Among all charities, our method yielded an output of approximately 1,500 combative and 30,000 supportive charities. This disproportionate categorization is not surprising in light of prior research showing significantly higher frequency for positive versus negative words (e.g., a 7:1 ratio for "love" vs. "hate," a 41:1 ratio for "beauty" vs. "ugliness"; Zajonc 1968; see also Johnson, Thompson, and Frincke 1960; Kloumann et al. 2012).

Validating the computer-generated classification. To validate the computer-generated classification, we chose a total of 300 cases—consisting of 100 cases each from the supportive, combative, and neutral categories from the coding output—at random and assigned them to two independent judges for an interrater reliability assessment. Judges were provided with a randomized list of charities and instructed to classify the charity as "for" when the name seemed most likely to be supportive, "against" when the name seemed most likely to be combative, and "neutral" when the name was deemed as neither supportive nor combative. We gave the judges hypothetical examples to aid them in categorizing (e.g., "Fund for the Environment" was marked as "for," "People Against Pollution" was marked as "against").

Next, we subjected the ratings to an interrater reliability test. We deemed an acceptable alpha level to be .70 (Lombard, Snyder-Duch, and Bracken 2002), interpreted as 70% agreement between the computer-based and independent judges' categorizations. We chose Krippendorff's alpha for its advantages in accounting for chance agreements and allowance of missing data (Hayes and Krippendorff 2007). In comparing the computer-based classifications and those of the two independent judges, an initial assessment of the 300 cases yielded an alpha of .69. To run a more conservative test, we subsequently removed 100 cases at random, resulting in 200 cases in total. This analysis yielded an alpha of .72. From these results,[4] we deemed the computer-generated classification acceptable for use in categorizing names as supportive, combative, or neutral. We next examine the impact of this name categorization on survival and revenue generation.

Examination of Long-Term Survival

Although it is possible for a charity to succeed financially through a multitude of one-time donors, its long-term viability can only be enhanced by its ability to receive ongoing donations. We use survival analysis to test our proposition that a supportively oriented charity would achieve greater survival compared with a combatively oriented charity.

Method. The primary measure of interest is that of the hazard function h(t), specifying the instantaneous risk of failure f at time t, conditional on a firm surviving up to that point in time. To control for key attributes of a charity, our

[4]Importantly, in examining combative and supportive names, only 2.5% of charities were misclassified as their opposite (e.g., classified as "for" by a judge when the computer coding schema classified it as "against").

model accounts for several covariates, whereby the hazard for charity i at time t is noted in Equation 1. The hazard for charity i is a fixed proportion of the hazard for any other charity j (see Equation 2), yielding the hazard ratio. For example, in our data, a hazard ratio of 1.15 for the combative orientation would represent a 15% greater risk of event versus a supportive orientation.

$$(1) \qquad h_i(t) = \lambda_0(t)\exp[\beta_1 x_{i1} + \beta_2 x_{i2}(t) + \ldots \beta_k x_{ik}(t)], \text{ and}$$

$$(2) \qquad \frac{h_i(t)}{h_j(t)} = \exp\left\{\beta_1\left(x_{il} - x_j\right) + \ldots \beta_k\left(x_{ik} - x_j\right)\right\}.$$

Applying Equation 1 to our analysis yields Equation 3, which models the hazard of charity i at time t as a function of NAME while accounting for time-varying covariates of AGE and ASSET as well as the time-invariant variables of CLASS, RATING, and STATE.

$$(3) \qquad h_i(t) = \lambda_0(t)\exp[\beta_1 NAME_i + \beta_2 AGE_i(t) + \beta_3 ASSET_i(t) + \beta_4 CLASS_i + \beta_5 RATING_i + \beta_6 STATE_i].$$

To determine whether an event occurred (i.e., if a charity ceased to operate within the ten-year time frame), we examined charities' tax filings by year. In addition to containing key measures on all 501(c)(3) organizations required to comply with submission of tax forms (e.g., Form 990, Form 990-EZ), the data are reconciled with the Business Master File of Exempt Organizations. The Business Master File includes information for all active and registered nonprofits applying for tax-exempt status. We also relied on the IRS guideline that any charity that does not file a tax return with its unique Employer Identification Number for three consecutive years is considered dissolved (IRS 2011). Per this guideline, we have complete visibility for a charity's dissolution through year 7 of the ten-year data. For example, a charity founded in 1996 with no filings from 2006 to 2009 would be recorded as an event in 2006 (at an age of ten).

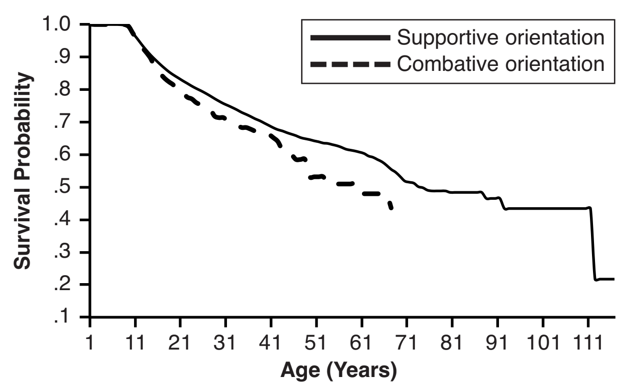
However, we do not know whether the charities that dissolved within the final three years of our ten-year data might have been revived. To address this issue, we obtained a list of active charities (as reported by the IRS) at the second and third years that came after our ten-year time frame.[5] The list consisted of two variables, name and Employer Identification Number, which enabled us to verify whether any of the charities originally classified as dissolved in years 8–10 might have resurfaced. We found that among the 2,995 charities showing dissolution in years 8–10, there were 478 revivals. In light of these findings, we recoded these charities as being "alive" and used them in the analysis that we discuss next.

Analysis and results. Before including covariates, we began with a test of homogeneity of survival for AGE over the NAME strata. Significance from the test of equality over strata (log-likelihood test) allowed us to reject the null hypothesis that NAME (combative vs. supportive orientation) had the same influence ($\chi^2(1, N = 38{,}226) = 7.78$, $p < .01$). The results indicate that combative charities experience a steeper decline in survival probability (relative to supportive charities) over time. Figure 1 provides a graphical representation.

Next, we conducted an analysis with the full set of covariates. First, given the left-censoring of the data, we began our analysis by examining only those firms founded within the ten-year data period (approximately one-third of all charities). The model as a whole was significant ($\chi^2(62, N = 14{,}588) = 3{,}091.42$, $p < .01$). Within this time frame, the hazard ratio of 1.19 for a combative (vs. a supportive) charity was not significant ($\chi^2(1, N = 14{,}588) = 1.65$, $p < .20$), presumably because of the limited time in which we could measure dropout. For example, the population of charities founded in our ten-year data provides us with an average of 4.61 years of data from which we could measure dropout (vs. a total of 9 periods for the full data set). Thus, with the average age of a charity being 23.6 years, we believed that expanding our examination beyond those charities founded in the 10-year period would allow us to more effectively test our hypothesis pertaining to long-term survival. In doing so, we (1) aimed to use a time frame that included more charities (because the charities founded within the 10-year time frame included only one-third of all charities) and (2) attempted to reduce instances of older charities that are more likely to have left-censored competitors. Therefore, we used charities within the grand mean age of 23.6 years, capturing more than 73% of the data. The model as a whole retained significance ($\chi^2(63, N = 28{,}007) = 11{,}255.11$, $p < .01$) and revealed a significant hazard ratio of 1.18 ($\chi^2(1, N = 28{,}007) = 4.34$, $p < .04$) for a combative (vs. supportive) charity. In other words, the results indicate that a combatively oriented charity is 18% more likely to experience an event relative to a supportively oriented charity. Appendix A includes the model details.

Discussion. The results from this analysis indicate that combatively oriented charities are less likely to survive compared with supportively oriented charities. However, survival is merely one measure of performance. Might another measure—such as revenue—tell the same story? That is, all else being equal, would a charity's ability to generate ongoing revenue be better for a supportive or combative orientation? A pattern of greater revenue for support-

Figure 1
SURVIVAL CURVES SUGGEST GREATER DURATION FOR A SUPPORTIVE (VS. COMBATIVE) ORIENTATION



[5]The first year after the ten-year time frame was unavailable, although we can use the list from the second year after our ten-year data to validate whether dissolved charities from year 8 were revived.

ively (vs. combatively) oriented charities over time would further reinforce our findings.

Examination of Firm Revenue over Time

In the next part of our analysis, we test whether the revenue-generating ability of supportively oriented charities would follow the same pattern as predicted by the hazard model. For example, although greater survival for supportive (vs. combative) charities implies greater revenue from increased donor interest over time, it is possible that, relative to combative charities, a supportive charity simply lingers in the market longer, with lower revenues.

Method. We employed hierarchical linear modeling (HLM) to analyze the longitudinal data. One advantage of HLM is that it provides the ability to enable user-defined covariance structures, whereby we assigned an autoregressive covariance structure (first-order autoregressive) in recognition of the homogenous variance and the correlation from more proximate observations of equally spaced measures of our dependent variable (Littell et al. 1996). Hierarchical linear modeling also affords a more flexible approach with regard to missing data (Shin 2009). In our analysis, we examined REVENUE as a function of NAME along with the same covariates included in our examination of survival. The full model, noted in Equation 6, builds from a two-level hierarchical model—that is, charities within name orientations. We include the time-varying variables of AGE and ASSET as Level 1 predictors of REVENUE (as noted in Equation 4), with a charity-specific intercept and a name-orientation-specific slope included in Level 2 (see Equation 5):

$$(4)\quad \textit{Level 1}: \text{REVENUE}_i(t) = \beta_{0i} + \beta_{1i}\text{AGE}_i(t) + \beta_{2i}\text{ASSET}_i(t) + \varepsilon_{ti};\ i = 1, \ldots, N,$$

$$(5)\quad \textit{Level 2}: \beta_{0i} = \gamma_{00} + \gamma_{01}\text{NAME}_i + \gamma_{02}\text{CLASS}_i + \gamma_{03}\text{RATING}_i + \gamma_{04}\text{STATE}_i + u_{0i},$$

$$\beta_{1i} = \gamma_{10} + \gamma_{11}\text{NAME}_i,$$

$$\beta_{2i} = \gamma_{20}, \text{ and}$$

$$(6)\quad \textit{Mixed}: \text{REVENUE}_i(t) = \gamma_{00} + \gamma_{01}\text{NAME} + \gamma_{10}\text{AGE}_i(t) + \gamma_{11}\text{NAME}_i \times \text{AGE}_i(t) + \gamma_{20}\text{ASSET}_i(t) + \gamma_{02}\text{CLASS}_i + \gamma_{03}\text{RATING}_i + \gamma_{04}\text{STATE}_i + u_{0i} + \varepsilon_{ti};\ i = 1, \ldots, N.$$

Analysis and results. Analysis began with an unconditional, intercept-only model, adding in a stepwise fashion NAME, AGE, NAME × AGE, ASSET, CLASS, RATING, and STATE. We used maximum likelihood to assess model significance, analyzing the difference in the Akaike information criteria (AIC) between each model and its preceding alternative. As we note in Appendix B, Model 5 results in optimal fit, which includes NAME, AGE, NAME × AGE, ASSET, and CLASS. We considered each of the variables included in this model and whether they exhibited a significant influence on revenue. The analyses did not reveal a significant main effect for NAME on REVENUE ($F(1, 27{,}963) = 1.70$, $p < .20$). However, a significant main effect did emerge for AGE ($F(1, 175{,}102) = 56.95$, $p < .01$), indicating greater revenue as a charity ages. In addition, significant effects emerged for covariates ASSET ($F(1, 175{,}102) = 13{,}904$, $p < .01$) and CLASS ($F(1, 27{,}963) = 53.34$, $p < .01$). Most pertinent to our prediction, we observed a significant effect for the AGE × NAME interaction ($F(1, 175{,}102) = 23.54$, $p < .01$), indicating greater revenue over time for supportive (vs. combative) charities.

Our main interest (and prediction) pertained to the influence of the interaction of NAME and AGE—that is, to examine whether the effect of a supportive versus combative orientation would differ over time. In interpreting these findings, the significant beta coefficient for the AGE × NAME interaction ($\beta_{\text{Combative}} = -.002$, $t(175{,}102) = -4.85$, $p < .01$) indicates that as a combative charity ages, its revenues experience a significant decrease relative to a supportive charity. Thus, considering two charities differing only on NAME, each at the mean AGE of 24 years, revenue for the combative charity would be 3.81% lower than that the supportive charity. That is, a combative charity loses 3.8% in incremental revenue as a result of its name orientation. From a revenue perspective, this differential can be significant for a charity seeking year-over-year growth amid a competitive market. Taking into account the average year 10 revenue of combative and supportive charities, this differential equates to nearly $25,000 in lost revenue for a combative charity. Over the average lifespan of a charity, the model predicts approximately $300,000 in lost incremental revenue for a cause associated with a combative orientation.

Moreover, considering the average annual revenue growth over the ten years of data, we further find that combative charities experience an annual growth of .23%, compared with supportive charities' growth of 6.23%. Importantly, when we compare these annual revenue percentages with inflation—which averaged 2.56% during this period (Bureau of Labor Statistics 2014)—we find that growth of a combatively framed charity falls short of inflation, making it less competitive and, we believe, contributing to its eventual inability to survive in the long run.

Finally, in our analysis we report the revenue and survival models separately because our a priori approach was to examine whether revenue followed the expected pattern from the initial survival analysis. However, we acknowledge that these separate models may not account for potential dependencies between the time-to-event and longitudinal outcomes from our survival and revenue examinations. Thus, to validate the inferences made from our separate models, we turn to joint modeling.[6] Our aim is to examine the relationship strength between revenue trajectory and survival for combative versus supportive charities.[7] Given this objective, we use the approach suggested by Wulfsohn and Tsiatis (1997) and Henderson, Diggle, and Dobson (2000). In this joint analysis, both the longitudinal (revenue) response and time-to-event (hazard) outcome are dependent on latent random effects U_i and V_i, each following a zero-

[6]We thank the associate editor for this valuable suggestion.

[7]That is, we were interested not in predicting survival but rather in testing survival across groups. In addition, we chose a joint model that considers variables from the same time frame because we assessed revenue and survival annually.

mean multivariate normal distribution. Thus, we restate our longitudinal model as

$$Y_i(t) = X_{i1}\beta_1 + U_{0i} + \varepsilon_{ti} \quad (7)$$

and the hazard model as

$$h_i(t) = \lambda_0(t) \exp\{X_{i2}\beta_2 + V_{0i}\}, \text{ where } V_{0i} = \gamma(U_{0i}). \quad (8)$$

In Equation 7, X_{i1} denotes the covariates from our original longitudinal model (i.e., Model 5 in Appendix B), and U_{0i} denotes the charity-specific random effect. In Equation 8, X_{i2} denotes the effect of NAME, with latent random effect V_{0i}. As Wulfsohn and Tsiatis (1997) discuss, the proportional random effects for the longitudinal and hazard models result in $V_{0i} = \gamma(U_{0i})$, with γ representing the association between the longitudinal and survival processes.

Our joint model consists of a longitudinal submodel including NAME, AGE, NAME × AGE, ASSET, and CLASS, with the survival submodel including the NAME effect as well as the time-varying effect of REVENUE as estimated from the longitudinal model. For the survival submodel, we chose an accelerated failure time Weibull model, a parametric approach commonly used in joint modeling (Ibrahim, Chu, and Chen 2010) that is closely related to the Cox model in that both assume proportional hazards and provide unbiased, equally efficient estimates of the hazard ratio (Carroll 2003). Furthermore, the Weibull model enables us to measure not only the hazard ratio (similar to Cox) but also the relative increase or decrease in survival time, aiding our interpretation of the effect of NAME on survival longevity. Thus, Equation 8 is restated in Equation 9 as a Weibull accelerated failure time model, which predicts the log of survival time as a function of NAME and the underlying REVENUE effect:

$$\text{Log}(T) = \alpha_0 + \alpha_1 X_{i2} + V_{0i}, \text{ where } V_{0i} = \gamma(U_{0i}). \quad (9)$$

The joint analysis validated results of the separate revenue and survival models. As Appendix C shows, we continued to observe a significant negative NAME × AGE interaction ($\beta = -.003$, $z(168{,}274) = -5.04$, $p < .001$) for the longitudinal submodel, indicating lower revenue for combative charities as they age. For the NAME coefficient in survival submodel (α_1 in Equation 9), we continue to find significance ($\alpha_{combative} = -.18$, $z(26{,}493) = -2.58$, $p < .01$). We also find significant positive association (noted as γ in Equation 9) between survival and revenue ($\gamma = 3.35$, $z(26{,}493) = 7.88$, $p < .001$), consistent with our prediction of greater survival with increased revenue. Specifically, the NAME coefficient indicates that a charity with a combative (vs. supportive) orientation has a 16.2% shorter life span. Moreover, the findings from the survival submodel translate to a hazard ratio of 1.22 for a combative orientation (calculated as $e^{-\gamma\alpha}$; see Allison 2010); that is, a finding similar to the separate survival analysis.

Accounting for self-selection. With a charity's name orientation being self-selected, standard analysis with NAME as an independent variable may lead to inconsistent and biased parameter estimates (Heckman 1979; Maddala 1983). In light of the nonrandom nature of a charity's name, an uncorrected effect for NAME may be correlated with the error term predicting REVENUE (see James 2006). To correct for potential self-selection, we implemented a two-step procedure (Heckman 1979; James 2006; Smits 2001; Vella 1998). We first estimated the self-selection process itself with a probit model predicting NAME orientation as a function of the available variables theorized to influence a charity's decision to frame itself as supportive or combative. Including the variables of AGE, CLASS, RATING, and STATE, this model as a whole was significant in predicting NAME ($\chi^2(65, N = 32{,}889) = 280.81$, $p < .01$). We then used these results to compute a self-selection adjustment for each charity, $\hat{\lambda}$, which we added to our proposed model to account for the potential effect of endogeneity. We obtained nearly identical results with this analysis, whereby we continue to observe a significant AGE × NAME interaction ($F(1, 175{,}102) = 4.87$, $p < .01$). Furthermore, a nonsignificant correction factor ($F(1, 175{,}102) = .79$, $p > .30$) suggested no main effect from self-selection on charitable revenue.

Additional controls. We added more control variables to our proposed model to account for two additional factors. First, we control for whether a charity's data were right-censored, thus addressing the issue that a "dying" charity might exhibit disproportionate losses in its later years. Second, as a proxy for expenditures a charity may incur in promoting its cause, we control for administrative expenses, despite its sporadic reporting (by approximately two-thirds of all charities). Both assessments show the same pattern relative to our proposed model. That is, we continue to see a significant AGE × NAME interaction (i.e., a pattern similar to our prior analyses) after accounting for the effects of right-censoring ($\beta_{right\text{-}censored} = -.01$, $t(27{,}963) = 5.65$, $p < .01$) as well as for expenses ($\beta_{expenses} = .05$, $t(93{,}787) = 110.07$, $p < .01$).

Discussion. The results of this analysis show greater revenue over time for supportive (vs. combative) charities, providing further evidence of supportively oriented charities' stronger long-term performance. These results hold both before and after accounting for survival, the possibility of self-selection bias, and expenses. The findings follow the expected pattern from the hazard model, which also shows a supportively oriented charity's ability to sustain. That is, both examinations point to a supportive charity prevailing in the long run.

However, we acknowledge that our empirical evaluation cannot address the multitude of exogenous factors that affect a charity's long-term performance. That is, several alternate accounts—such as the overall frequency of combative versus supportive orientations and its effect on the charity's popularity (as discussed in our theoretical background)—could produce similar results. Thus, in the sections that follow, we present field and lab studies to examine in depth the role of one possible mechanism: regulatory focus theory.

CHARITY FIELD STUDY

Given the evidence provided by the aggregate-level charity data, we conducted a field study to test our propositions at the individual (donor) level, involving actual pledges for a 501(c)(3) public charity. We approached a charity that was collecting responses from members and nonmembers about their intent to donate their time to various events throughout the fiscal year. The charity allowed us to frame its cause before the pledges were solicited. We created a supportive and combative version of the cause, which the charity included in a survey aimed at soliciting pledges. Thus, we were able to control for the type of charity and frame the same cause supportively or combatively. Participants in this field study indicated the amount of hours they were willing to donate. Those who did not want to make a pledge for any of the events indicated zero as their response. In line with the findings of the IRS charity data, we predicted that the supportive orientation is more likely to garner greater pledges over time than the combative orientation. Moreover, the field study enabled us to test whether the proposed effect would emerge for donations of time rather than money.

Method

We approached a mountain biking advocacy organization (in the recreation and sports segment in the Human Services domain) to gather data from its members during its annual pledge drive. Fifty-nine current and prospective members completed a survey administered by the charity as part of its annual pledge efforts. The 59 respondents included 20 existing members and 39 prospective members who had shown some interest or had taken part in past events; thus, all respondents were aware of the charity's objectives and considered them relevant. A link to an online survey/pledge form was posted on the organization's website to aid in its planning for the upcoming season. Contributions were solicited as time from the donors (rather than money) because the organization mostly asks for volunteer hours to help build and maintain trails in the area. Thus, donations of time were more applicable than donations of money. Ten events, spaced evenly and organized chronologically throughout the charity's fiscal year, were presented, and the donors indicated the total hours they would be willing to pledge for each event. Specifically, respondents viewed a series of four screens, each pertaining to a season in which events were planned (i.e., spring, summer, fall, and winter). For each event within a given season, respondents saw a numerical field that required him or her to enter a time pledge greater than or equal to zero hours.

After clicking the link to complete the survey, respondents were randomly assigned to either a combative or supportive orientation for the charitable cause, which was included as part of the larger survey. Given that we were working with a charity whose name was already well established,[8] we were able to manipulate the orientation (tone) of the messaging as supportive versus combative. The supportive orientation read, "[Charity Name] supports the preservation, expansion, and enhancement of natural surface trail systems throughout the [region] area in an effort to ensure continued access to high quality, well-maintained trails," whereas the combative orientation read, "[Charity Name] fights the neglect, downsizing and deterioration that has plagued many natural surface trail systems throughout [region] in an effort to eliminate low quality, poorly maintained trails." Respondents were then directed to the pledge portion of the survey, where they entered their time pledge for each of the ten chronologically presented events. Respondents then concluded the survey by answering questions pertinent to the charity's planning efforts and unrelated to our research propositions.

Results

We examined the dependent variable of hours donated as a function of the charity's combative or supportive orientation. To control for any effects from participants' membership status, we used it as a covariate. For the key predictor of name orientation, the results revealed that a supportive orientation resulted in greater overall donation of time ($\beta_{\text{supportive}} = .49$, $t(56) = 2.18$, $p < .04$). The covariate of membership status was significant, with members pledging less time than nonmembers ($\beta_{\text{members}} = -.55$, $t(56) = -2.35$, $p < .03$).

The data enabled us to test an aspect of regulatory focus theory, in addition to examining the impact on donation of time. Because the respondents indicated a value either equal to or greater than zero, we were able to preliminarily test for whether respondents were considering donating or deferring their donations for later.[9] Importantly, deferral of donations helped us connect the responses to predictions made by regulatory focus theory, which suggests that prevention-oriented consumers are more likely to defer choice (Dhar 1997) to avoid mistakes (Pham and Higgins 2005). Applied to our charitable context, if a combative orientation activated a prevention focus, this might result in more instances of the donors deferring on the choice to donate in a given period. Therefore, we would be more likely to observe more zero donations among respondents assigned to the combative (vs. supportive) condition. In the long run, this should result in a smaller amount donated overall, adversely affecting the revenue collected (or time donated) for combatively oriented charities.

Therefore, we dichotomized the dependent variable of hours as "donated" versus "not donated." That is, we categorized any period in which the respondents pledged time as "donated," with any period of a zero donation categorized as a donation deferral or as "not-donated." We ran a logistic regression model, with the probability of a zero donation predicted by name orientation while controlling for membership status. The results indicated that the log of the odds of the charity receiving a zero donation was greater for the combative orientation ($\beta_{\text{combative – supportive}} = .59$, $t(56) = 2.73$, $p < .01$). More specifically, the odds of a combative orientation having a zero donation were 1.81 times greater than a supportive orientation. In comparing nonmembers with members, we observe directional evidence for greater probability of zero donations for nonmembers ($\beta_{\text{nonmembers – members}} = .43$, $t(56) = 1.93$, $p < .06$).

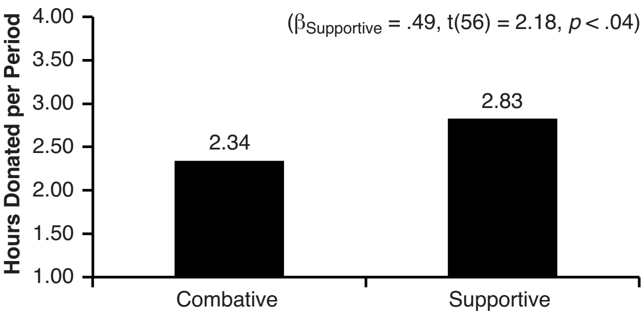
Discussion

The results of the field study (as summarized in Figure 2) help us test the findings from the charity data in a more controlled yet realistic setting (i.e., individual, donor-level responses). First, the field study replicates the result of the charity data by demonstrating that a supportive orientation is more likely to garner higher donations. Moreover, we find that the results hold even when we consider donations of time rather than money and when we track individual-level rather than aggregate contributions. Finally, though preliminary, the field study enabled us to test for the role of regula-

[8]The charity name was neutral and was commonly referred to by its initials; therefore, we could cleanly manipulate combative and supportive messaging that accompanied the name.

[9]Note that we provide a more direct test for deferral of donations in the next study. However, we can obtain some insights from the presence of zeros in this study.

Figure 2
CHARITY FIELD STUDY: GREATER DONATION FOR A SUPPORTIVE (VS. COMBATIVE) ORIENTATION



tory focus through the presence of zero donations. We find that a combative orientation results in greater deferral (captured through zero donation values) and thus behaves in a manner similar to a prevention orientation.

In summary, from this field study we conclude that a supportive orientation is likely to prevail over a combative one. However, although respondents indicated their donations to ten events, they entered their pledges in one sitting; that is, pledges were not elicited over time. Thus, despite donation intent being measured by actual pledges to an existing charity, one could argue that intent was not measured over time. Moreover, the support for deferral was preliminary because respondents were not explicitly deferring donations. To address these concerns and gather more evidence for the theoretical propositions, we conducted a longitudinal lab study.

LONGITUDINAL LAB STUDY

The longitudinal lab study enables us to test whether the same charity oriented as supportive versus combative would replicate our previous results. To address the concerns of the field study, we designed the lab study in such a manner that the same charity was oriented differently (combatively or supportively) and that donations (money and time) were elicited longitudinally. In other words, by manipulating only the message orientation and controlling for other factors, we manipulated the regulatory focus that would be activated by the charity's orientation. Finally, to more effectively test for deferral of donations, we gave participants the option of donating within a specific period or deferring to the next period.

To ensure that participants were actually donating (vs. indicating intent to donate) to the charity, we designed a procedure such that each week participants were asked to complete a task whereby they were provided with monetary remuneration on the basis of their performance. They were then provided information about a charitable organization in a purportedly unrelated task (appearing along with other filler tasks) and asked if—and how much—they would donate to the charity from the amount they just earned. Thus, a participant's donation was from money that he or she had actually earned, with the maximum donation based on a consistent amount that could be earned each week. Moreover, we wanted to directly test whether a supportive orientation triggered a promotion focus and a combative orientation triggered a prevention focus. We measured this in a pretest with a different sample of participants from the main study, thus eliminating any carryover effects that could influence the main study participants.

Pretest

The pretest enabled us to test two important factors. First, we wanted to ensure that the charities we were using in the main study—though framed differently as supportive versus combative—had a similar impact and conveyed a similar meaning to the donors. In addition, we also wanted to choose a charitable domain that our participants found relevant. Second, the pretest enabled us to test whether a prevention versus a promotion orientation was activated on the basis of the name used. We recruited 80 participants from an online panel in return for monetary compensation and randomly assigned them to a combative or supportive condition. Within each condition, participants evaluated five charitable messages in the Urban Development, Environment, Education, Business/Commerce, and Animal-Related domains. Each charity description consisted of a headline, body copy, and tagline presented in either a combative or supportive orientation (for details, see Appendix D). Participants first indicated whether the given charity appeared "supportive" versus "combative" on a seven-point bipolar scale. To shed light on whether the charity triggered a promotion versus a prevention focus, we also asked participants to indicate their responses to scale items assessing the type of regulatory orientation that was activated. In the absence of extant scales specifically measuring orientation for a marketing message or brand name, we created a seven-point bipolar scale including six scale items adapted from keywords in promotion/prevention descriptions from Higgins, Shah, and Friedman (1997) and Higgins (1998). The scale items included the following pairs of keywords describing regulatory focus: promotion versus prevention, hope versus duty, aspiration versus responsibility, approach versus avoid, nurture versus protect, and wish versus obligate. Finally, to understand the relevance of the charitable domain to the participants, we asked them to rank the charities from most to least important.

The results indicated that in terms of relevance, the domains of Education, Environment, and Animals were at or above the median, with Urban Development and Business/Commerce below the median. Results from the six regulatory focus scale items indicated that, except for the domain of Education, a supportive name resulted in participants rating it as more promotion oriented, whereas a combative name resulted in a more prevention-oriented rating. Therefore, the results of the pretest indicated that a supportive orientation activated a promotion focus, whereas a combative orientation activated a prevention focus. Because we needed two charitable domains to provide donors with choice in the main study, we selected the Environment and Animal domains on the basis of their above-median performance on the relevance measure and a clear promotion versus prevention delineation, as noted in Appendix E, Panels A–C.

Method for the Main Study

Ninety-one undergraduate students were recruited in return for partial course credit to take part in the study. Before the study began, we invited participants to an information session and gave them detailed instructions on the procedure. During this information session, participants completed a brief questionnaire that collected their e-mail addresses and demographic data. They were informed that the study would last for five weeks and that each week they would be given a marketing task to complete. At the end of each week, they would receive an e-mail with a link to a questionnaire. By clicking on the link, they would first input the information they had collected for the marketing task assigned for that week. Importantly, they would earn monetary compensation for these efforts. The maximum amount they could earn each week was $5. The questionnaire would also provide them with information about the task for the next week as well as other items for them to complete.

Those enrolled in the study were then contacted at a set frequency each week. First, they provided the information they had collected on the assigned marketing task (for a complete list of tasks by week, see Appendix F). After providing this information, we informed participants how much they had earned from their work on the task. To ensure that participants earned approximately the same amount of money, we randomly chose an amount between $4.60 and $5.00, which was presented to them after a delay of 30 or more seconds of processing time. The time delay and the randomized compensation were aimed at creating the feeling that participants' responses were being scrutinized and that their resulting compensation would be based on their responses. Afterward, participants completed the charitable donation task. Specifically, in the first week they were presented with two supportive or combative charities from the Environment and Animal domains (from the pretest) and asked to select the more important charity. This selection would serve as the target charity used for that participant in subsequent weeks. Each week, participants were asked whether they would be willing to donate to the same charity from the amount they had earned in the marketing task, with those willing to donate entering a dollar amount. Notably, the question soliciting monetary donations for each of the five periods included the choices of "Yes, I would like to donate" or "No thank you. Not this week" (with the latter choice modeled after tactics commonly used by charities to better allow for donation requests in subsequent periods). Thus, we were able to test for deferral of donations. Subsequent to the monetary donation request, participants were asked to contribute as much or as little time as they wanted to a task aimed at helping out the charity (as a proxy for donation of time).

Finally, participants answered five questions aimed at measuring feelings or affective involvement toward the charity. Our rationale for including this scale was to provide another test for regulatory focus theory. Importantly, research on feelings transfer in goal systems (Fishbach, Shah, and Kruglanski 2004) has suggested that the tone associated with a goal's attainment (in our case, a combative vs. supportive tone) can influence the process of achieving the goal. That is, the feelings experienced during goal pursuit mirror the feelings experienced when the goal is achieved (Spence 1956). Importantly, research has shown that the intensity of feelings experienced when a goal is achieved (in our case, donating to a cause) is greater under a promotion versus a prevention focus (see Idson, Liberman, and Higgins 2000). To measure feelings specific to charitable situations, we used the affective and moral reaction questions suggested by Small, Loewenstein, and Slovic (2007).

The five-point scale items (ranging from "not at all" to "extremely") included the following questions: (1) How upsetting is this situation to you? (2) How sympathetic did you feel while reading the description of the cause? (3) How much do you feel it is your moral responsibility to help out with this cause? (4) How touched were you by the situation described? and (5) To what extent do you feel that it is appropriate to give money to aid this cause? Before concluding each week's questionnaire, participants were given information about the next week's marketing task.

Results

Monetary donations. There was no significant difference in money earned between participants randomly assigned to supportive orientations (who, on average, earned $4.81) and combative orientations (who earned $4.82 on average). When participants were given the option to choose a domain of either Environment or Animal, we observed a 60% choice of Environment domain and 40% choice of Animal domain ($z = 1.92$, $p < .10$). Furthermore, no significant differences surfaced in earnings or donations between the two domains. Over the five weeks, three participants dropped out of our panel (two participants after the first week and one participant after the second week), resulting in 88 total participants. In comparing donations between the two name conditions, we found that the total monetary donations for the combative (vs. supportive) condition were significantly lower ($\beta_{combative} = -.66$, $t(86) = -5.22$, $p < .01$). Specifically, donations in the supportive condition amounted to $.79 (or approximately 16% of participants' weekly earnings) per period, while donations in the combative condition averaged $.13 (or 3% of earnings) per period.

Deferral on monetary contributions. Similar to the field study, to examine deferral of monetary donations, we again created an outcome of "donated" versus "not donated" for the dependent measure of monetary donation. That is, we categorized any time period in which participants chose the "No thank you. Not this week" option as "not donated." A logistic regression model indicated that the log of the odds of a combative charity receiving a zero donation was significantly higher than a supportive charity ($\beta_{combative - supportive} = .82$, $t(86) = 3.16$, $p < .01$). More specifically, the odds of a combative charity having a zero donation was 2.27 times greater (i.e., $e^{.82}$) than a supportive charity.

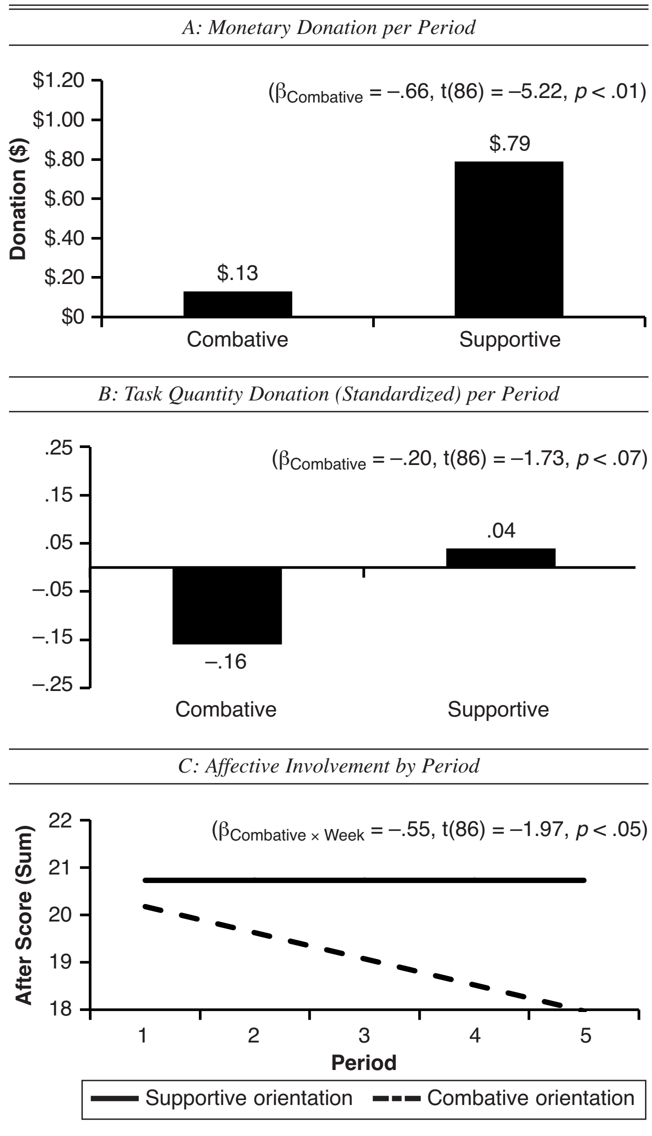
Time donation. We next considered participants' donations of time/effort to the five charity tasks requested of them. We calculated a variable of task involvement that measured depth of interaction within a given task and consisted of the quantity of output produced. For example, in week 1, the task involved generating a list of viable brand partners for cause-related marketing efforts by the participant's chosen charity. We calculated the task involvement for this round as the number of ideas generated. For other list-based tasks, such as in weeks 2 (soliciting banner ad copy) and 4 (generating search keywords), the total number of items participants entered served as the task involvement measure. For tasks calling for paragraph responses (e.g., a donor e-mail letter in task 3, input on funding campaigns in task 5), task involvement was the total number of words typed. Of the 88 participants, 61 donated their time in at least one of the five weeks, yielding a total of 275 observations over time. We first standardized the task involvement dependent variable for comparability across periods and removed four observations that were more than three standard deviations above the mean.[10] In predicting the dependent variable of task involvement across the two name conditions, we find directional evidence for lower task involvement in the combative versus supportive condition ($\beta_{combative} = -.20$, $t(86) = -1.73$, $p < .07$). Specifically, we find that the combative orientation results in a task involvement measure that is .16 standard deviations below the mean, whereas the supportive orientation results in a measure that is .04 standard deviations above the mean.

Affective involvement. Finally, we summed each of the five seven-point affective scale items to provide a total affect score, with higher scores indicating greater affective involvement. Our decision to sum each of the five responses was based on two factors: (1) a Cronbach's alpha greater than .85 for each individual period and (2) a factor analysis confirming our a priori criteria that all measures would load onto a single factor explaining at least 70% of total variance (per Stevens 1992). We ran a repeated-measures analysis of variance (ANOVA) across the two name orientations over the five time periods as well as a name orientation × time period interaction. Both name orientation and time, in isolation, are insignificant ($p > .25$). However, we observe a significant name orientation × time period interaction. Specifically, the affect score for the combatively oriented charity decreases over the five weeks ($\beta_{combative \times week} = -.55$, $t(86) = -1.97$, $p < .05$) compared with the supportively oriented charity, which indicates that participants assigned to the combative condition experience a reduction in affective involvement as time progresses. We depict the results in Figure 3, Panels A–C.

Discussion

The results from the longitudinal lab study provide further evidence that a supportively oriented charity is more likely to garner higher monetary donations in the long run, which is likely to increase its chances of survival. Moreover, we find directional evidence of greater charity involvement as captured through the task involvement variable for the supportive orientation. Finally, we find that the affective involvement with a combative (vs. supportive) orientation decreases over time. Theoretically, this study accomplished several things. First, by changing just the messaging orientation—or activating a promotion or prevention focus through the name and supporting tone of the charity—we were able to replicate our previous results. Second, the pretest provided direct evidence that a supportively oriented charity activated a promotion focus, whereas a combatively oriented charity activated a prevention focus. Third, similar to the field study, we again find that choice deferral is more likely for a combatively oriented charity than for a supportively oriented charity, highlighting the former's prevention-focused nature. Fourth, through the affective involvement scales, we determine that a supportive charity is more likely to lead to sustained positive affect with the cause, providing evidence in line with goal systems theory, which suggests a transfer mechanism of positive and negative affect from supportive and combative orientations, respectively.

Figure 3
LONGITUDINAL LAB STUDY: GREATER DONATION AND INVOLVEMENT FOR A SUPPORTIVE (VS. COMBATIVE) ORIENTATION



GENERAL DISCUSSION

In this research, we examine whether a combative versus supportive orientation is likely to prevail in the long run. Although extant research stemming from prospect theory and loss aversion (Tversky and Kahneman 1981) varies with the context, in general it supports the notion that negative messaging garners greater attention. However, because much of this previous research examines a short time frame, and because there has been relatively little research in the realm of charitable contributions, we examined whether a combative versus supportive orientation for a charity is likely to succeed in the long run. We utilized three types of data to answer this question: aggregated firm-level data, time pledges from prospective donors to an actual charity, and a longitudinal

[10]Of the four removed observations, two were from the supportive condition (SD = +4.57 and SD = +3.06 in week 4) and two were from the combative condition (SD = +3.5 in week 3 and SD = +3.86 in week 5).

panel with donor-specific monetary and time measures. Across our empirical investigations, we find that a supportively oriented charity is more likely to endure compared with a combatively oriented charity. For the aggregate charity data, we find that a supportive orientation is more likely to survive for longer and earn greater revenue. To validate these findings in a controlled yet realistic setting, we conducted field and longitudinal lab studies. Both these studies again showed (for monetary as well as time donations to charities) that a supportive orientation garners higher levels of donations over time compared with a combative orientation.

In addition to our demonstration of the effect, we proposed and tested the theoretical mechanism causing the effect. Utilizing regulatory focus theory, we proposed that a supportively (combatively) oriented charity activates promotion (prevention) motivations. Prior research has shown that a promotion focus is likely to lead to more goal-directed actions, greater affective involvement, and less choice deferral. Thus, a supportively oriented charity is likely to generate greater donations and survive for longer because it activates a promotion focus. Through our field study and longitudinal lab study, we demonstrate that a supportive (combative) orientation activates a promotion (prevention) focus and leads to less donation deferral and greater affective involvement. Moreover, we infer that global, top-down processing for a supportively oriented charity encourages a greater amount of time invested in the cause, which we find in our field and lab studies in the form of time donations and task involvement.

Although we do test for the role of regulatory focus in our lab study, we acknowledge that regulatory focus is just one of the mechanisms at play in causing the proposed effect. That is, it is possible that other mechanisms—such as the less-frequent occurrence of negative names, the greater liking for positive names, or social influence of seeing others donate to a specific charity—could contribute to the proposed effect. Thus, it would be worthwhile for further research to parse out these explanations in greater detail. Moreover, future studies could examine consumer choice among several charitable alternatives or assess value through paired choice study (e.g., conjoint). Further research notwithstanding, our findings provide several theoretical and practical applications, which we discuss next.

Theoretical Implications

From a theoretical perspective, this research first informs extant research on the influence of message orientation on long-term persuasion. Although extensive research has shown that negatives tend to outweigh positives in a point-in-time examination, relatively little work has empirically examined this influence over time. Through our longitudinal empirical examinations, we demonstrate that a supportive orientation tends to prevail relative to a combative orientation. Second, our findings have implications for branding as well as signaling theory research. For branding, our research indicates that a combative name might not endure (e.g., achieve long-term brand relevance) relative to a supportive name. Furthermore, it is possible that signaling the brand's intent in a supportive versus a combative frame might result in greater performance over time. Third, in examining the longitudinal influence, we are able to inform extant theory on regulatory focus by linking supportive and combative tones to promotion and prevention orientations, respectively. Fourth, literature in economics has suggested that people engage in altruistic acts for a variety of reasons (Andreoni 1990; Rose-Ackerman 1996), and our findings help inform how one aspect—a charity's message orientation—can influence people's altruistic behavior differently in the short and the long run.

Practical Implications

This research also has many practical implications. First, understanding the impac t of a supportive or combative orientation is significant for firms in choosing the most appropriate frame on the basis of their strategic intent. We address the unique situation faced by nonprofits, which work under the constraints of advertising and promotion dollars, and discuss how they can utilize the name and/or accompanying message tone of their organization to sustain long-term contributions. Second, for brand names or taglines outside the charitable domain, the findings from this research could be used to predict the long-term effect of a positive orientation (i.e., emphasizing a product's benefits) versus a negative orientation (i.e., eliminating unwanted consequences). Third, extending these findings to the policy or political realms, this article could help determine strategy using a temporal focus. Specifically, our research can aid decision making in line with whether the goal for return is immediate (e.g., a one-time exchange) or long term (e.g., forging an ongoing relationship). Fourth, our research illustrates the importance of using longitudinal data to understand the various factors that have a temporal influence. Over time, people encounter new influences, acquire new learning, and alter their attitudes and behavior accordingly. Thus, short-term predictions might not hold in the long run.

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Appendix A

SURVIVAL ANALYSIS: SIGNIFICANTLY GREATER HAZARD FOR COMBATIVE (VS. SUPPORTIVE) NAME ORIENTATION

A: Type 3 Tests

Variable	*d.f.*	χ^2	p
NAME	1	4.34	.037**
AGE	1	162.72	<.001***
ASSET	1	127.73	<.001***
CLASS	4	6.16	.188
RATING	3	8,808.60	<.001***
STATE	53	85.15	.003***

B: Analysis of Maximum Likelihood Estimates

Variable		β	*SE*	χ^2	p	*Hazard Ratio*
NAME	Combative	.17	.08	4.34	.037*	1.18
AGE		–.04	.00	162.72	<.001**	.958
ASSET		–14.76	1.31	127.73	<.001*	.000
CLASS	Arts and Culture	.08	.06	1.85	.174	1.080
	Education	–.00	.05	.00	.988	.999
	Health	.09	.05	3.42	.065	1.091
	Human Services	–.01	.04	.04	.850	.993
RATING	A	–5.47	.07	6,297.09	<.001**	.004
	B	–5.43	.07	6,396.25	<.001**	.004
	C	–2.48	.06	1,525.59	<.001**	.084
STATE	Individual state/territory coefficients have been withheld from this table.					

*$p < .10$.
**$p < .05$.
***$p < .01$.

Appendix B

HLM DETAIL: MODEL 5 (OPTIMAL AIC); RESULTS SHOW LOWER REVENUE OVER TIME FOR COMBATIVE CHARITIES

	Model 0	*1*	*2*	*3*	*4*	*5*	*6*	*7*
AIC	–402,174	–402,177	–404,503	–404,514	–417,719	–417,888	–417,875	–417,556
AIC versus prior		–3	–2,326	–11	–13,205	–169	13	319
AIC versus minimum		15,711	13,385	13,374	169	0	13	332
AIC weight		<.0001	<.0001	<.0001	<.0001	.9985	.0015	<.0001
INTERCEPT	15.742**	15.742**	15.724**	15.724**	6.776**	6.771**	6.776**	6.751**
NAME (Combative)		–.017**	–.015**	–.004	–.005	–.006	–.006	–.006
AGE			.003**	.003**	.002**	.002**	.002**	.002**
NAME × AGE (Combative)				–.002**	–.002**	–.002**	–.002**	–.002**
ASSET (Log)					.492**	.492**	.491**	.492**
CLASS								
Arts and Culture						–.002	–.003	–.004
Education						.013**	.013**	.013**
Health						.032**	.031**	.030**
Human Services						.011**	.011**	.012**
RATING								
A							.011*	.011*
B							.005	.005
C							.001	.001
STATE	Individual state/territory coefficients in Model 7 have been withheld from this table.							

*$p < .01$.
**$p < .01$.

Appendix C

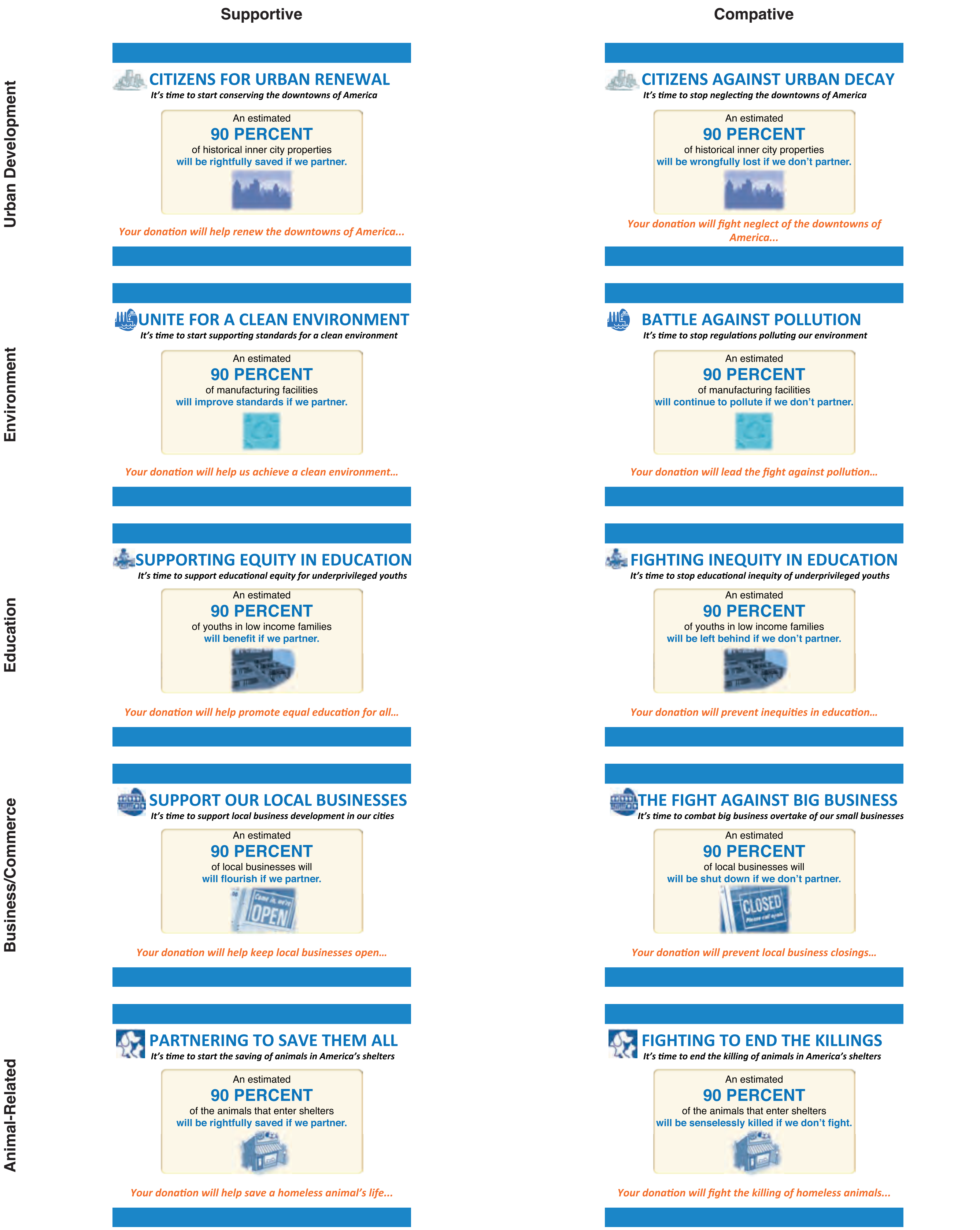
JOINT LONGITUDINAL AND SURVIVAL MODEL: VALIDATES FINDINGS OF LOWER REVENUE OVER TIME AND LOWER SURVIVAL FOR COMBATIVE CHARITIES

A: Longitudinal Submodel						
Variable	*Label*	*β*	*SE*	*d.f.*	*z*	p
INTERCEPT		15.726	.001	26,493	10,853.52	<.001**
NAME	Combative	–.001	.004	26,493	–.20	.8433
AGE		.001	.000	168,274	12.10	<.001**
NAME × AGE	Combative	–.003	.001	168,274	–5.04	<.001**
ASSET (Log)[a]		.073	.000	168,274	254.55	<.001**
CLASS	Arts and Culture	.009	.002	26,493	5.35	<.001**
	Education	.071	.002	26,493	32.73	<.001**
	Health	.010	.002	26,493	7.06	<.001**
	Human Services	–.001	.002	26,493	–.76	.4457
	Other	.000				
B: Survival Submodel						
Variable	*Label*	*Coefficient*	*SE*	*d.f.*	*z*	p
INTERCEPT		–48.967	6.682	26,493	–7.33	<.001**
NAME (α)	Combative	–.177	.069	26,493	–2.58	.0098*
ASSOCIATION (γ)		3.349	.425	26,493	7.88	<.001**
SCALE (Log)		.130	.014	26,493	9.31	<.001**

*$p < .01$.
**$p < .001$.
[a]We standardized the ASSET variable (M = 0, SD =1) to aid in model convergence.

Appendix D

PRETEST STIMULUS (COMBATIVE VS. SUPPORTIVE BY DOMAIN)



Appendix E
PRETEST RESULTS

A: Supportive Versus Combative Ratings by Condition[a]					
	Condition			ANOVA	
	Combative	Supportive	Δ	F	p
Urban Development	4.00	5.08	–1.08	8.44	.005
Environment	3.51	4.57	–1.06	6.18	.015
Education	4.97	5.32	–.35	.90	.344
Business/Commerce	3.58	5.70	–2.12	30.86	.000
Animal Related	3.16	4.78	–1.62	12.2	.000

B: Promotion/Prevention Score by Condition[b]					
	Condition			ANOVA	
	Combative	Supportive	Δ	F	p
Urban Development	31.40	24.41	6.99	22.82	.000
Environment	33.53	24.68	8.85	41.94	.000
Education	23.79	16.97	6.82	14.26	.000
Business/Commerce	29.18	16.78	12.40	65.14	.000
Animal Related	30.51	23.84	6.67	15.37	.000

C: Ranking Data by Domain				
	Condition		ANOVA	
	Median Rank	Average Rank	Lower 95% CI	Upper 95% CI
Urban Development	4	3.96	3.73	4.20
Environment	2	2.46	2.21	2.72
Education	2	2.25	1.96	2.54
Business/Commerce	4	3.38	3.06	3.69
Animal Related	3	2.95	2.63	3.27

[a]Rated on a seven-point scale (1 = "Combative," and 7 = "Supportive").
[b]Sum of six seven-point scales, with higher score being more prevention focused.
Notes: CI = confidence interval.

Appendix F
PANEL STUDY TOPICS BY WEEK

Week	Topic
Week 1	
Marketing task	Generate a total of four headline and four tagline/slogan ideas on the basis of body copy for an Apple print advertisement.
Donation task	Generate a list of viable brand partners for the charity (for cause-related marketing efforts) and rank these in order of importance.
Week 2	
Marketing task	Assess, rank, and comment on various out-of-home media being considered for best-in-class awards in their respective product categories. Assessments will help an independent advertising federation in awarding the "Best Outdoor Ad."
Donation task	Help the charity by crafting banner advertising elements that will drive consumers to a charity/fundraising site. Then, recommend specific websites on which the banner ad(s) should run.
Week 3	
Marketing task	Define four distinct product segments within the beverage category. [For all brands of which participants were aware, they were to assign each brand to their previously defined categories.]
Donation task	Generate e-mails to both prospective and repeat donors for the charity in the form of a "Thank You" letter.
Week 4	
Marketing task	For each of three actual print advertisements, complete an advertising positioning statement indicating the target, the competition, the key benefit, and the key functional attribute.
Donation task	Assist in the charity's donation efforts through eBay's Giving Works by (1) writing a mission statement, (2) including possible search keywords, and (3) selecting/budgeting product categories in which to promote the charity.
Week 5	
Marketing task	View a series of ads as part of an actual print advertising campaign and complete three key areas of the creative brief including target, role of the communication, and recommended media venues.
Donation task	Assist the charity in providing recommendations on how to best craft a holiday giving campaign, providing input in five key areas.

[a]Donation tasks in weeks 1 and 2 were presented only when participants agreed in advance to donate time. For weeks 3–5, the time task was presented to all participants, asking them to complete as much or as little as they preferred.